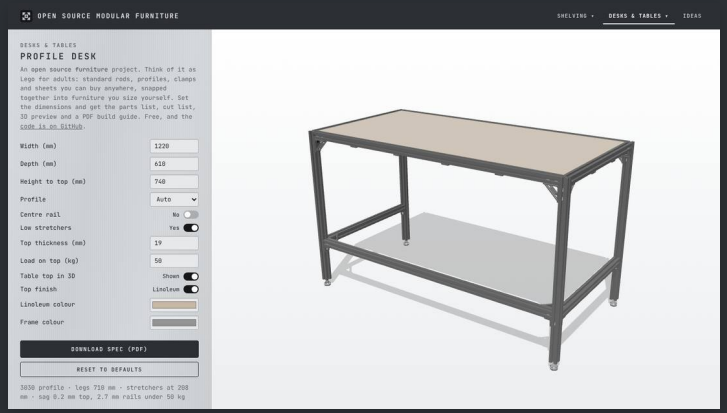
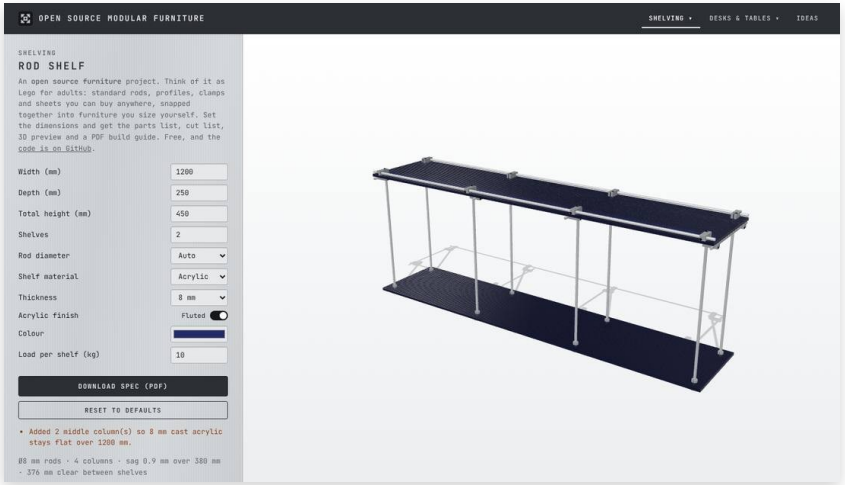
Design furniture with us

How to contribute to Open Source Modular Furniture with the Claude desktop app. No coding needed: you design, Claude builds.

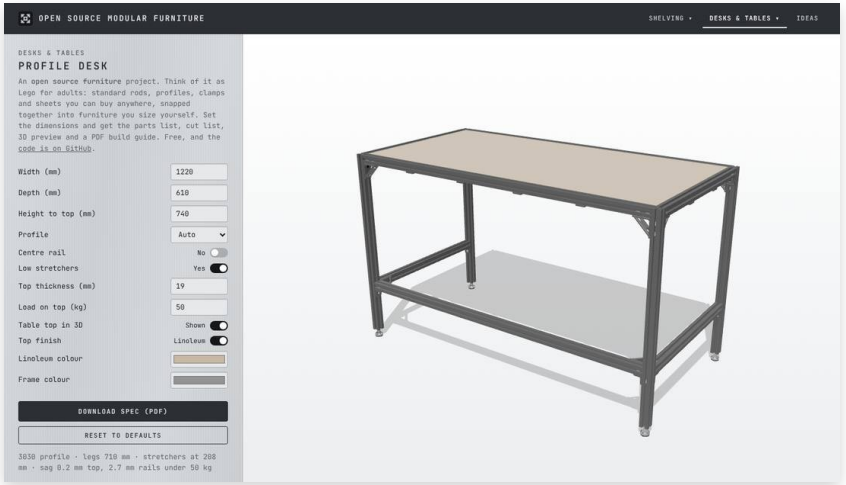


Lego for adults, sized by anyone

Standard parts you can buy anywhere, snapped together into furniture people size themselves. Each piece is a page on the site, picked from the top menu: a configurator.

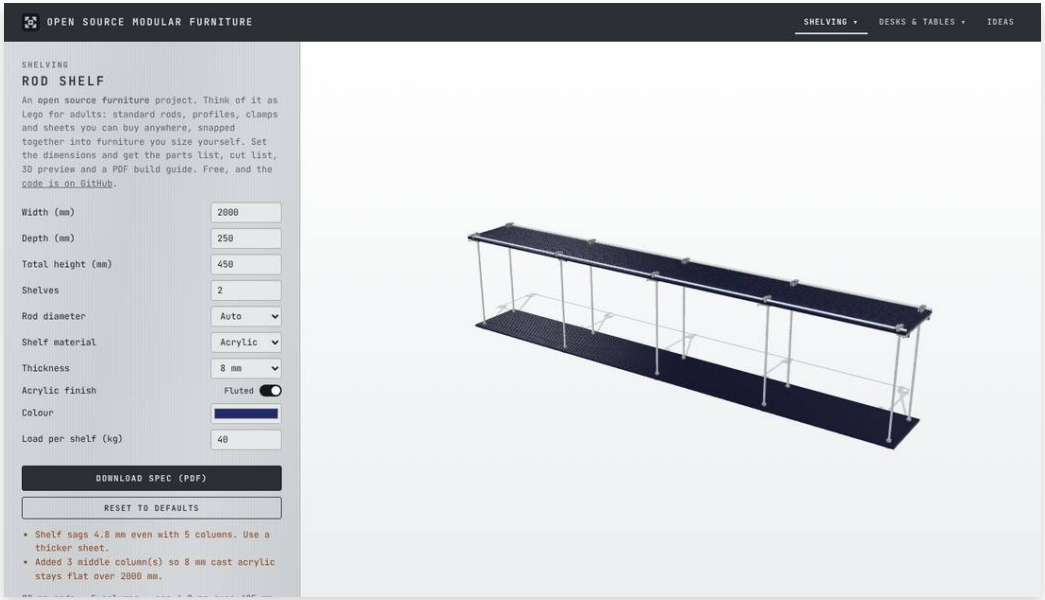


Rod shelf: chrome rods, cross clamps, acrylic or wood sheets



Profile desk: T-slot aluminium, brackets, plywood top

What a configurator gives people



1. **Settings**
   Width, depth, height and options, with sensible limits

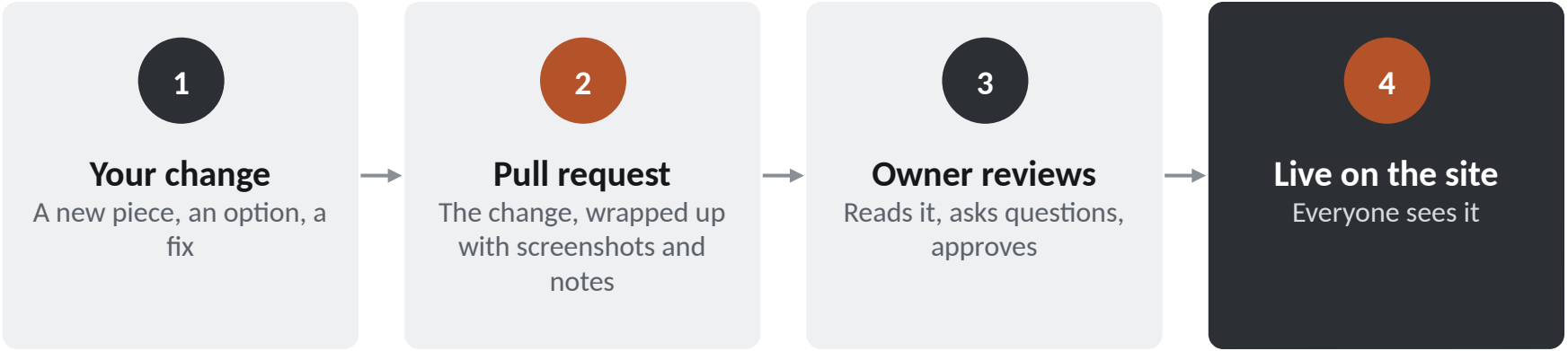
2. **Rules and warnings**
   At 2000 mm the shelf adds middle columns and warns it still sags

3. **3D preview**
   Click any part to see what it is and where to buy it

4. **Parts list and PDF**
   Exact quantities, cut lengths and an IKEA-style build guide

What is a pull request?

A pull request (PR) is a proposed change to the site. It holds everything you changed, and once the owner approves it, that change becomes what everyone sees on the site.



Nothing reaches the real site until the owner says yes, so you can't break anything.

The goal: try it first



This private copy is a "non-production" version: production is the real site everyone uses.

You design, Claude builds

You, the designer

- What the piece is and how it looks
- Which real parts to buy, and their sizes
- How it goes together, step by step
- What people can change, and the limits
- Saying "yes, that looks right" or "move this"

Claude, in the desktop app

- Runs the private copy of the site for you
- Writes the code and the tests
- Shows you what changed after every round
- Saves versions as it goes
- Creates the pull request

Before you start, once

1

A GitHub account

Free, at github.com/signup. GitHub is where the project lives.

2

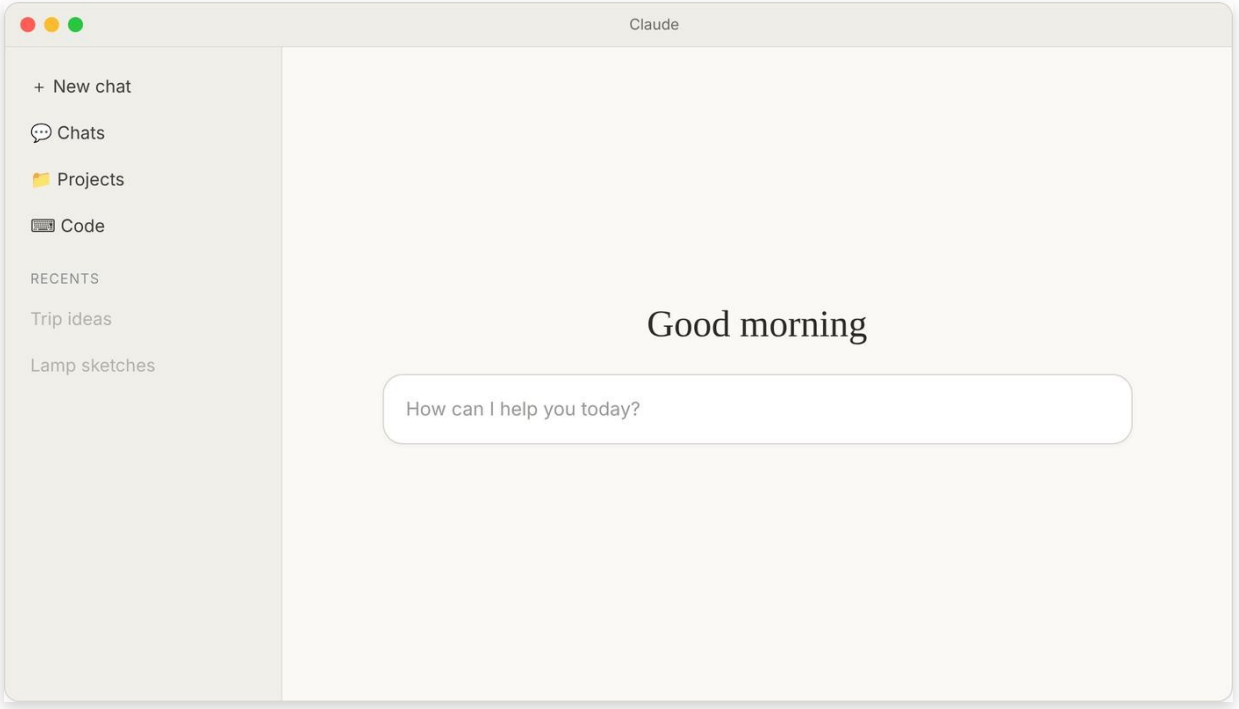
The Claude desktop app

Download it from claude.ai/download, install it and sign in.

That's all the setup. Everything else (downloading the project, running the site, your own copy on GitHub) is prepared, and Claude does it for you.

Step 0: open the Claude app

ILLUSTRATION



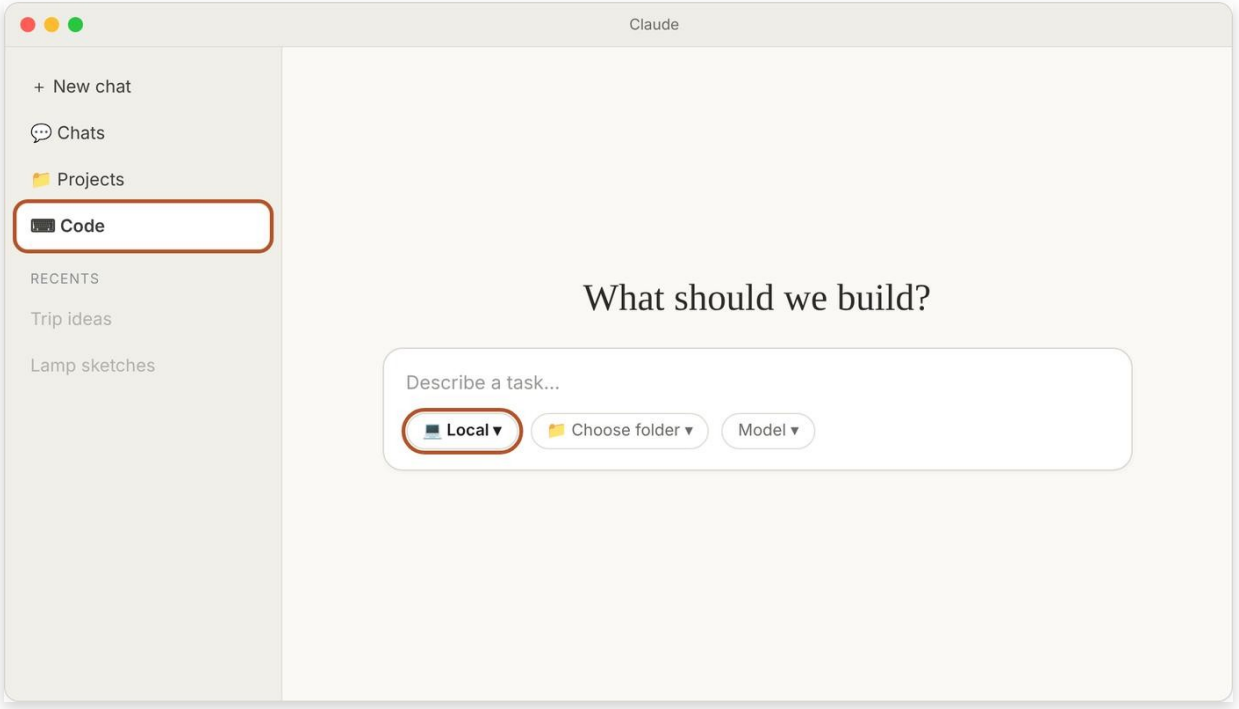
0

Open Claude

Open the Claude desktop app from your Applications (Mac) or Start menu (Windows), and sign in if asked.

Step 1: Code, then Local

ILLUSTRATION



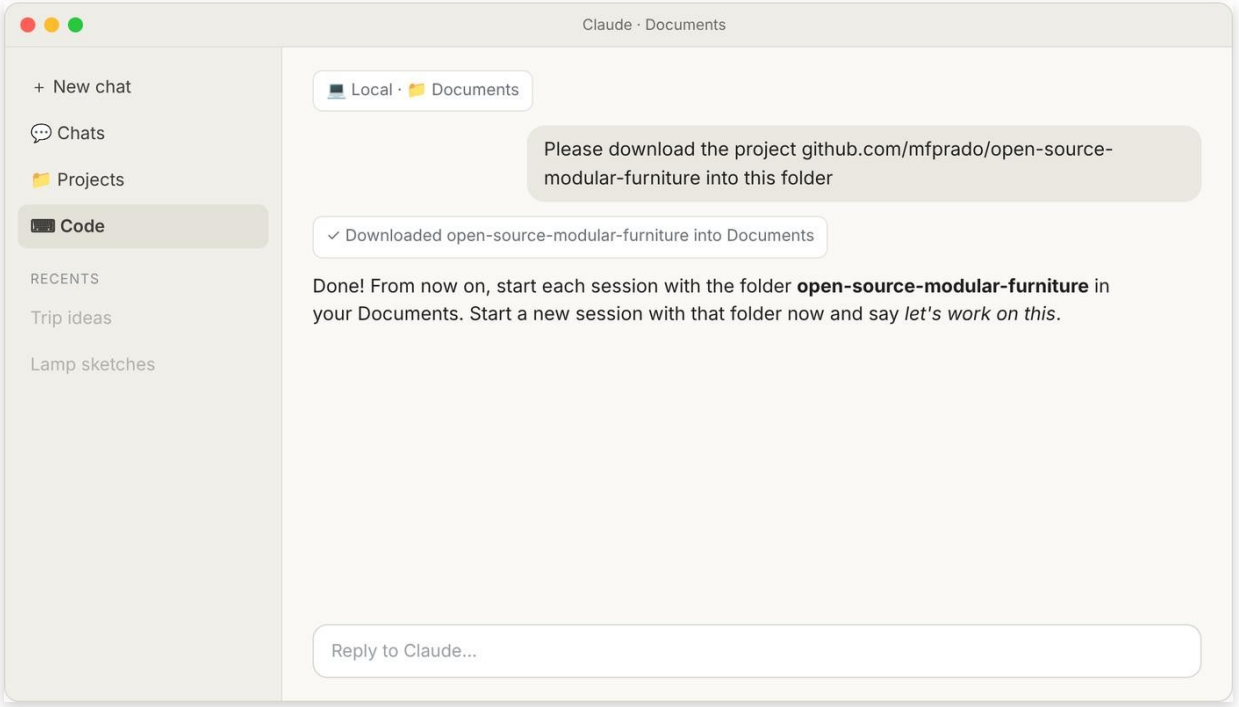
1

Click Code, pick Local

In the sidebar, click Code. Under the message box, set the environment to Local: Claude then works on your computer, so the site opens in your own browser.

First time only: get the project

ILLUSTRATION



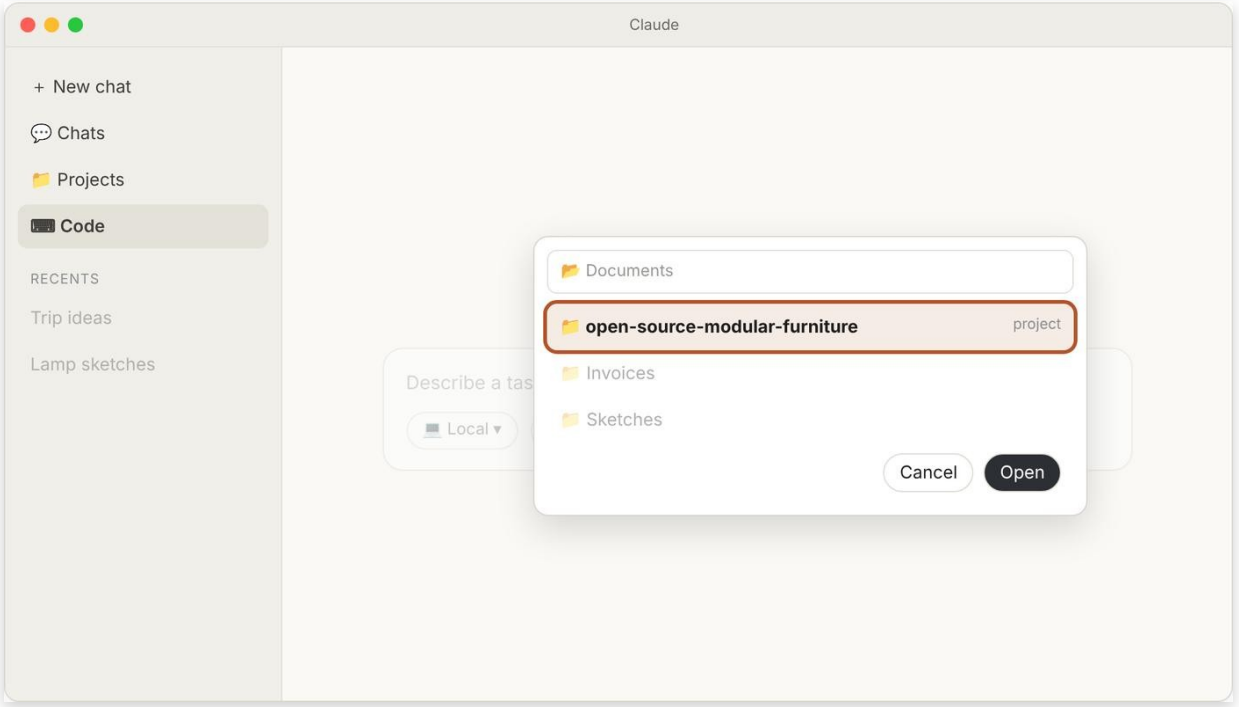
1×

Claude downloads it

Choose your Documents folder and ask Claude to download the project. Do this once; afterwards the project lives in Documents.

Step 2: choose the project folder

ILLUSTRATION



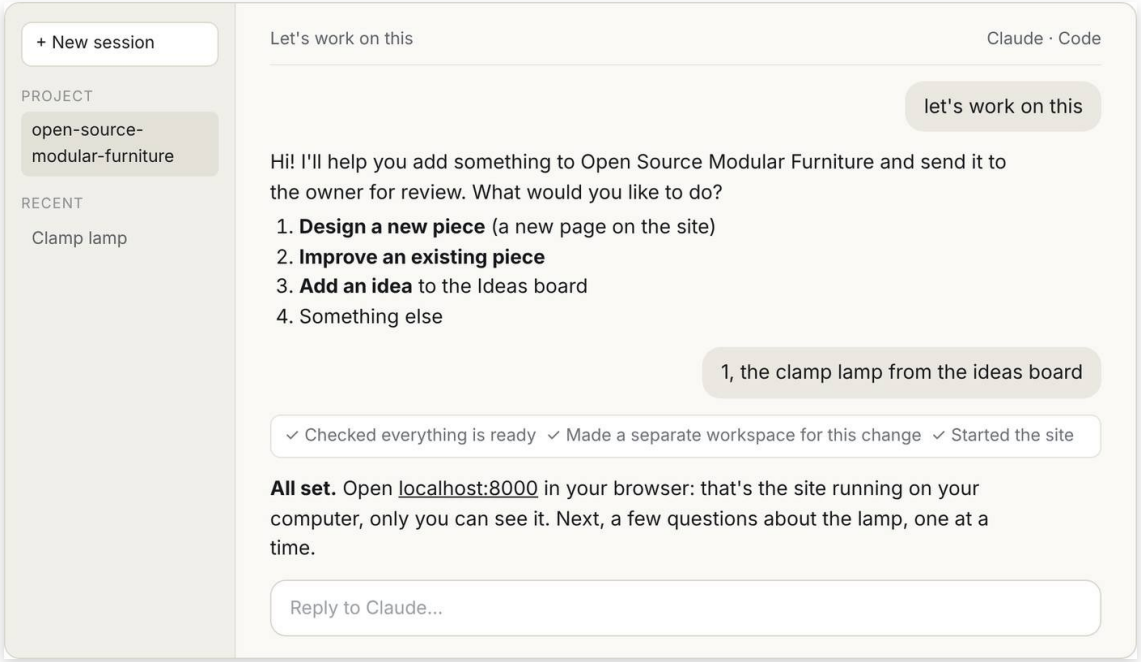
2

Pick the folder

Click Choose folder and pick open-source-modular-furniture in your Documents. Do this at the start of every session.

Step 3: say "let's work on this"

SIMULATED EXAMPLE

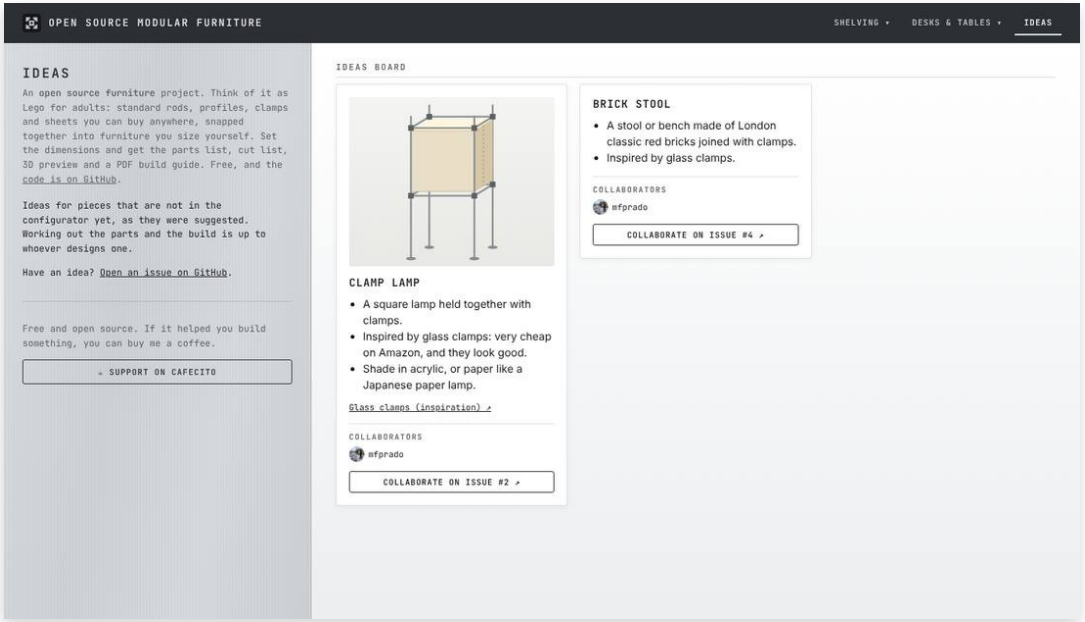


Everything is prepared
The project carries step-by-step instructions for Claude, so it knows how to guide you.

It asks what you want
Design a new piece, improve one, add an idea, or something else.

It starts your private copy
And tells you where to open it.

Not sure what to make?

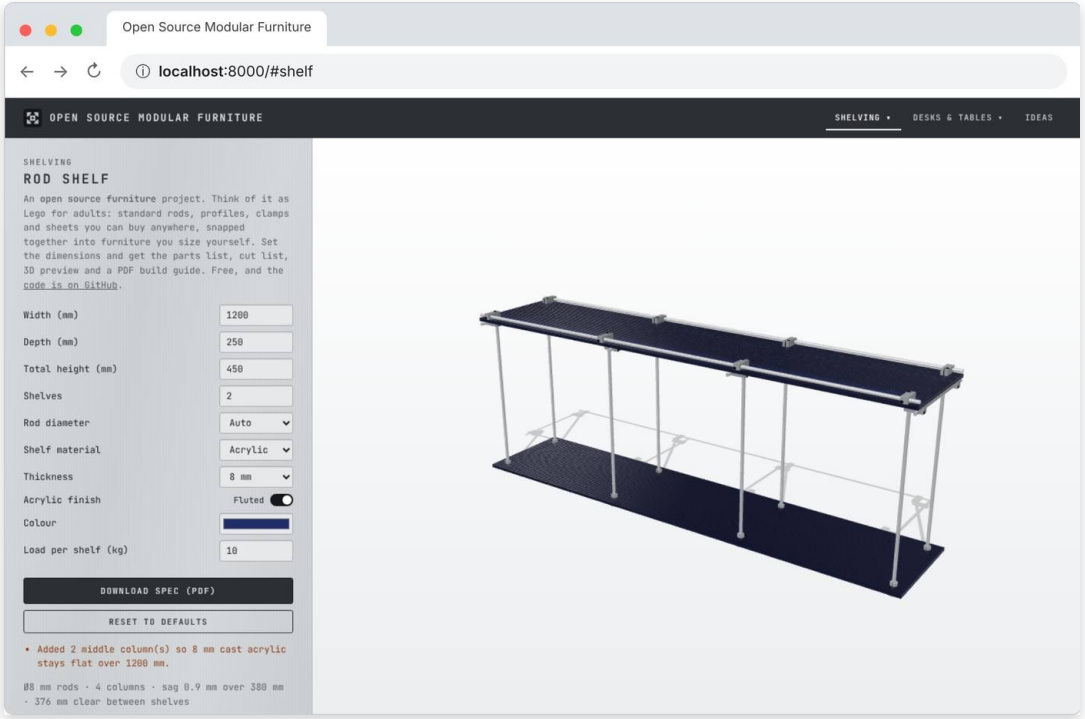


The Ideas page (top bar, right) lists pieces nobody has designed yet, each with an open GitHub issue.

Pick one, or bring your own.

Tell Claude which one; it reads the issue and its pictures.

Your private copy of the site



The real site
`mfprado.github.io/…`
Production: the shop window. Everyone sees it. It only changes after the owner approves.

Your private copy
`localhost:8000`
Non-production: the prototype on your workbench. Only on your computer, and it shows your changes straight away.

Open it in Chrome, in three moves

1

Claude starts it

At the start of the session. Keep the chat open: closing it switches the copy off.

2

Type localhost:8000

Open Chrome, click the address bar at the top, type localhost:8000 and press Enter.

3

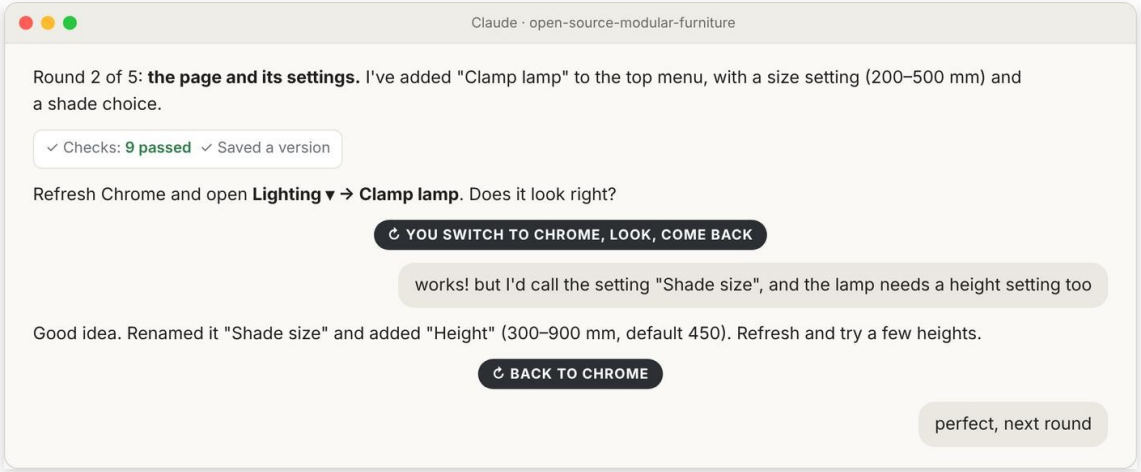
Refresh after each change

Press Cmd+R on a Mac or Ctrl+R on Windows to see what Claude just changed.

"This site can't be reached"? The copy is switched off. Nothing is broken: just ask Claude to start the site again.

Work in rounds: chat, look, repeat

SIMULATED EXAMPLE



Claude makes one change
And tells you exactly where to look.

You switch to Chrome
Refresh, try it, come back to the chat.

You say what you think
In plain words: "rename this", "add a height setting", "perfect".

Each round is saved, so nothing is lost if you change your mind.

New piece? It starts with a brief

SIMULATED EXAMPLE

docs/designs/clamp-lamp.md

Clamp lamp

A square lamp held together with clamps; shade in paper or acrylic. Idea: #2.

Parts

Part	Sizes available	Key dimensions	Source
Chrome rod	Ø8 mm	cut to length	listing link, read 2026-10-27
Glass clamp	for Ø8 rod	reach: unknown	listing link
Shade panel	paper, 3 mm acrylic	size × height	designer

Settings on the site

Setting	Default	Min	Max	Step / choices
Size (mm)	300	200	500	10
Shade	Paper	Paper / Acrylic		

Rules (example values)

• Legs are 1.3 × the shade height. • A second frame ring when the shade is taller than 400 mm.

Warnings

• Acrylic shade over 400 mm: check the bulb's heat rating.

Unknown, to measure

• How far the glass clamp reaches from the rod.

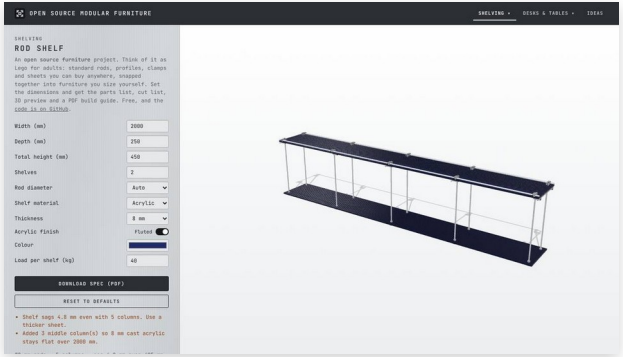
An interview first
Claude asks one question at a time: parts, sizes, how it goes together, what people can change.

Written down as a brief
You approve it before anything is built.

Unknown means unknown
Any size not on a listing goes on a "to measure" list.

Before sending: try it all

- ✔ Smallest and largest sizes
- ✔ Each option on and off
- ✔ Make each warning appear
- ✔ Click parts in the 3D view
- ✔ Find it in the top menu
- ✔ Download and read the PDF
- ✔ Shelf and desk still work
- ✔ Narrow window, like a phone

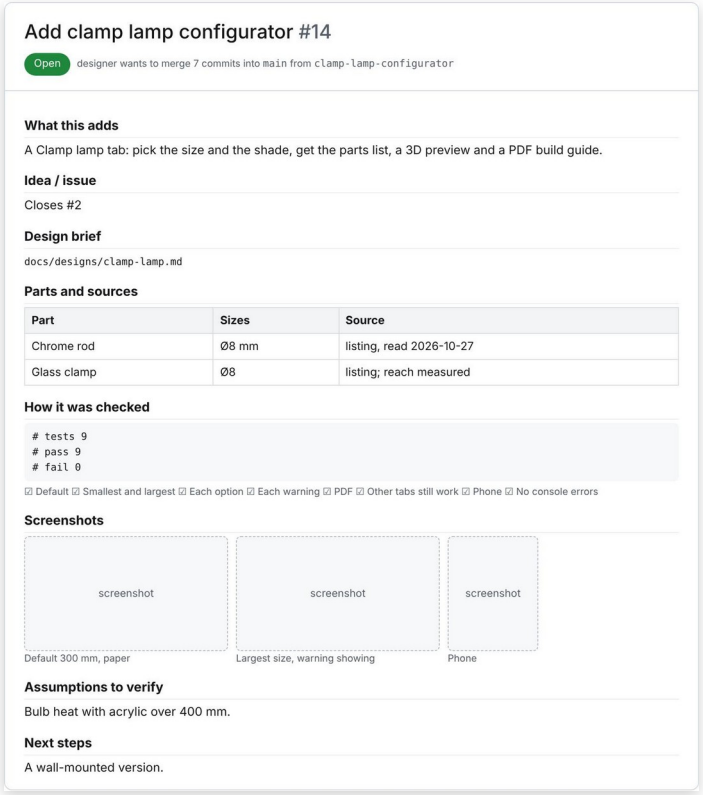


Real example: making a warning appear (2000 mm wide, 40 kg)

Found something odd? Tell Claude, refresh, check again.
Then Claude runs its own checks and takes the screenshots for the pull request.

Last step: Claude creates the PR

SIMULATED EXAMPLE



Add clamp lamp configurator #14

Open designer wants to merge 7 commits into main from clamp-lamp-configurator

What this adds

A Clamp lamp tab: pick the size and the shade, get the parts list, a 3D preview and a PDF build guide.

Idea / issue

Closes #2

Design brief

docs/designs/clamp-lamp.md

Parts and sources

Part	Sizes	Source
Chrome rod	Ø8 mm	listing, read 2026-10-27
Glass clamp	Ø8	listing; reach measured

How it was checked

```
# tests 9
# pass 9
# fail 0
```

☑ Default ☑ Smallest and largest ☑ Each option ☑ Each warning ☑ PDF ☑ Other tabs still work ☑ Phone ☑ No console errors

Screenshots

screenshot — Default 300 mm, paper

screenshot — Largest size, warning showing

screenshot — Phone

Assumptions to verify

Bulb heat with acrylic over 400 mm.

Next steps

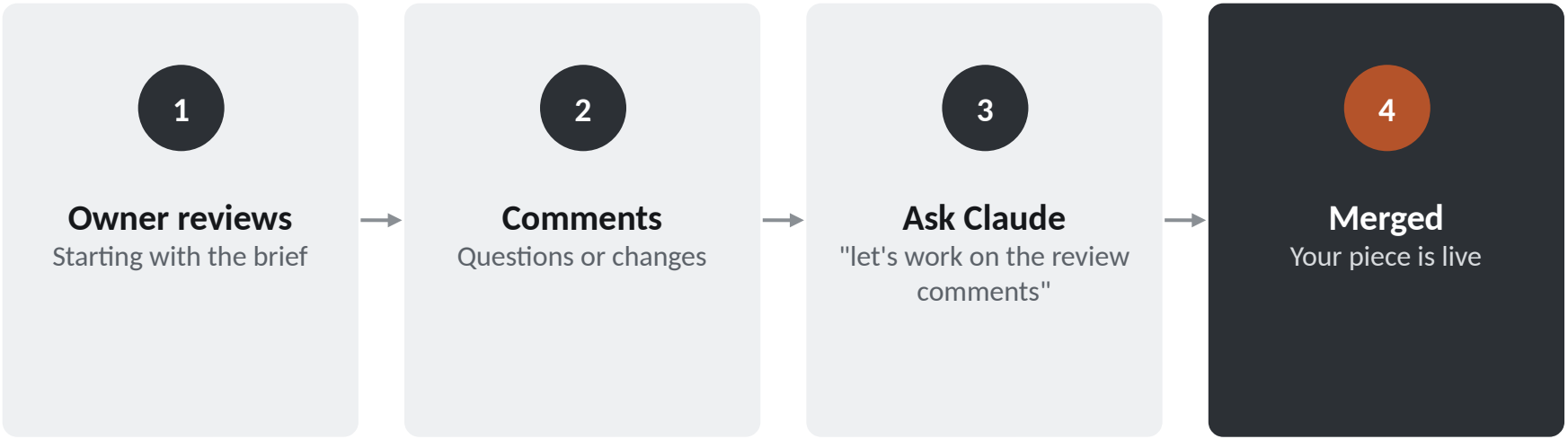
A wall-mounted version.

When you say "I'm happy, let's send it", Claude writes the pull request in a standard shape:

1. What this adds
2. Idea / issue
3. Design brief
4. Parts and sources
5. How it was checked
6. Screenshots
7. Assumptions to verify
8. Next steps

Your one job: drag the screenshots into it on GitHub.

After you send it



Changes go on the same pull request: open Code again (Local, the project folder), and Claude picks up the comments.

Three things to say

Claude app → Code → Local → folder open-source-modular-furniture, then:

```
"let's work on this"
```

```
"I'm happy, let's send it"
```

```
"let's work on the review comments"
```